

The Glass Meridian

PDF TEXT-LAYER TRANSLATION FIXTURE

Northlight Station stood on a shelf of black volcanic rock where the western sea narrowed into a channel. From the mainland, its tower looked like a pale needle pushed through the horizon.

Ships used its lamp, weather offices used its instruments, and the people of Greyhaven used it whenever conversation failed.

"Did they send you the calibration weights?" Mara asked.

"They were here yesterday," Elias replied.

"Were?" she prompted.

A brass rail spiraled upward around the central machinery well. Far below, something struck at a steady interval: not quite a bell, not quite a hammer, but a patient metallic heartbeat.

The page also contains 15.75%, v2.4.1, {{station_id}}, and <https://example.com/manual?id=42&mode=safe> for preservation tests.

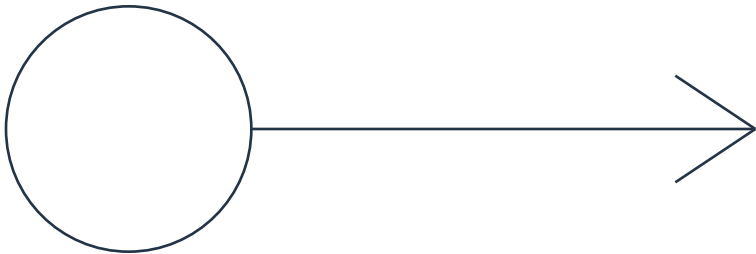
Inspection Notes

- Confirm that every extracted item remains a separate translation unit.
- Keep URLs, numbers, version strings, and placeholders unchanged.
- Preserve page order even when translated text grows longer.

The source includes a compact table-like region below. PDF files do not carry reliable table semantics, so the output intentionally reflows the extracted text instead of pretending to preserve cell geometry.

Term	Meaning	Required handling
Bell	mechanical signal	translate consistently
Keeper	station operator	retain role context
Drift	timing deviation	do not summarize

A vector diagram is present only to verify that non-text artwork does not prevent text-layer extraction.



Long-form Continuity Sample

At dawn on the third day, Mara returned to the lower gallery with a new notebook and no expectation of finding an easy answer. The delayed ninth beat had become stronger overnight, yet every gauge insisted that the assembly was operating within its legal tolerance.

Elias placed the missing calibration case on the workbench without explaining where it had been found. Its brass corners were wet with salt water, while the paper inventory inside remained perfectly dry. Mara recorded both facts before asking the question he clearly hoped to avoid.

"If the room was locked, who carried this outside?" she asked. Elias looked toward the shaft and answered, "That depends on whether you believe the station keeps time, or whether time keeps the station."

The sentence sounded theatrical, but the machinery below them answered with three quick impacts and a long silence. For the first time since her arrival, the eastern clock advanced by exactly one minute.

This final paragraph is deliberately long enough to wrap across several visual lines. The importer should reconstruct it as a coherent unit, the translator should receive neighboring context according to the selected mode, and the generated PDF should add pages instead of clipping text at the bottom margin.